SHORT · NOTEBOOK

What is a Databricks notebook?

A Databricks notebook keeps code, explanations, and results together. Work is organized into cells instead of one long script.

Key points

- A code cell holds instructions, such as Python. Run it on compute and the result appears below the cell.
- A text cell explains what the code is doing.
- A later cell can use a variable from an earlier cell. Run the earlier cell first, or the variable may not exist yet.
- Saving the notebook keeps the code. It does not keep variables into a new session. Run from the top for a repeatable lesson.

Tiny example

Illustration of the Short: one cell stores a number, the next adds one. This is not a captured output.

```
# code cell 1
value = 1

# code cell 2 — run cell 1 first in this session
print(value + 1)
```

Misconception check

> Saving a notebook does not save its variables. A new session still needs the cells run in order from the top.

Remember

A notebook brings code and its results into one place.

The Short says you can practice this in Databricks Free Edition.